

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Chronology and evidence discipline

VEDIC HORIZON -> rta, sacrifice, sacred speech and speculative hymns

EARLY UPANISHADS -> brahman, atman, karma, rebirth and moksha debates

6th-5th c. BCE -> second urbanisation and shramana challenges

EARLY HISTORIC -> sutra traditions and sharper school identities

2nd c. CE -> RS Sharma places Badarayana's Brahmasutra

EARLY MEDIEVAL -> commentary, logic and later doxographic ordering

RULE: date texts and school formation cautiously; use rival-source triangulation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: An argumentative field, not one doctrine

DARSHANA -> a viewpoint or way of seeing

ANVIKSIKI -> inquiry as a named knowledge branch

QUESTIONS -> What is real? How is knowledge valid? What binds? What liberates?

METHODS -> dialogue + aphorism + commentary + debate + disciplined practice

WORLDLY AIMS -> dharma + artha + kama

LIBERATION AIM -> moksha develops alongside worldly concerns

VERDICT: plurality and contest are structural, not later exceptions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Vedic to Upanishadic transition

RTA / YAJNA / SACRED SPEECH

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speculative hymns question origin, order and knowledge

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Aranyakas and Upanishads interiorise ritual and stage dialogues

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BRAHMAN + ATMAN + KARMA + REBIRTH + RELEASE

CONTINUITY: inherited vocabulary and ritual setting

CHANGE: knowledge and self-inquiry gain sharper liberating force.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Shramana reconfiguration

CONTEXT -> towns + states + merchants + renouncers + debate

BUDDHISM -> conditioned arising, non-self, suffering and disciplined path

JAINISM -> jiva, karmic matter, many-sidedness and rigorous restraint

AJIVIKA -> niyati and ascetic discipline; mostly hostile external evidence

LOKAYATA -> materialist and sceptical critique; texts largely lost

COMMON MOVE -> challenge ritual monopoly and rethink action, bondage and release

LIMIT -> shramana schools disagreed profoundly with one another.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Buddhist philosophical development

EARLY CORE -> four truths + dependent arising + non-self

ABHIDHARMA -> analytical classification of experienced processes

MAHAYANA -> bodhisattva horizon and expanded textual worlds

MADHYAMAKA -> emptiness as dependent existence, not nihilism

YOGACARA -> analysis of cognition and representation

DIGNAGA TRADITION -> sharper Buddhist epistemology and logic

CAUTION: later developments must not be projected into the earliest canon.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Jain, Ajivika and Charvaka evidence matrix

JAINA -> own canons + later texts | jiva, karma, anekanta, syadvada

AJIVIKA -> Buddhist/Jaina reports + archaeology | niyati; hostile-source problem

CHARVAKA -> opponents' summaries | perception and materialist criticism

ANEKANTAVADA -> reality has multiple aspects

SYADVADA -> conditional predication; not random indecision

HARD RULE -> secure core claim before later anecdote

VERDICT: source survival shapes how confidently each school can be reconstructed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Astika, nastika and the six-school caveat

ASTIKA / NASTIKA != simple believer / atheist

CLASSIFICATION AXES -> Vedic authority, other world and polemical usage

SIX LATER ORTHODOX PAIRINGS:

Samkhya <-> Yoga

Nyaya <-> Vaisheshika

Mimamsa <-> Vedanta

OLDER TRADITIONS -> real; neat six-school canon -> later crystallisation

TRAP: do not make one timeless list govern every ancient century.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Samkhya and Yoga

SAMKHYA

purusha / prakriti

three gunas

real evolution of prakriti

analytic tattva sequence

discrimination liberates

LINK: conceptual analysis <-> practical discipline

CAUTION: historical layers complicate one fixed founder-date story.

YOGA

related metaphysical framework

disciplined transformation of mind

citta-vritti-nirodha

eight-limbed practice

disciplined insight liberates

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Nyaya and Vaisheshika

NYAYA

valid knowledge

perception + inference

comparison + testimony

five-member inference

public reasoning

LINK: epistemic method <-> analysis of what exists

TRAP: Indian atomism is not identical to modern particle physics.

VAISHESHIKA

categories and substances

atomistic analysis

qualities, motion and inherence

padartha classification

realist ontology

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Mimamsa and early Vedanta

PURVA MIMAMSA

Vedic injunction and dharma
ritual hermeneutics
language and duty
textual authority central

UTTARA MIMAMSA / VEDANTA

Upanishads + Gita + Brahmasutra
brahman, self and liberation
competing later interpretations
textual authority central

BOUNDARY: early core != Shankara/Ramanuja projected backward

VERDICT: shared canon can sustain sharply different philosophical projects.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Pramana and metaphysics comparison

KNOWLEDGE -> perception | inference | comparison | testimony | other debates

SELF -> enduring self | plural selves | no-self | material person

CAUSATION -> transformation | new production | dependent arising

REALITY -> substance/categories | process | non-dual readings | plural aspects

LIBERATION -> knowledge | discipline | duty | ethical restraint | path

METHOD -> compare schools on one axis at a time

TRAP: do not assign every pramana to every school.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Institutions, language and answer spine

TRANSMISSION -> teacher lineages + monasteries + courts + debate halls

LANGUAGE -> Sanskrit + Pali + Prakrit + grammatical analysis

FORM -> sutra -> commentary -> counter-commentary

OPEN -> philosophy as a chronological, plural argumentative field

BODY -> Vedic/Upanishadic -> shramana -> darshana comparison

EVIDENCE -> named text or thinker + source limitation

CLOSE -> cumulative borrowing and contest, not spiritual homogeneity.